FaujPrep

PMA LONG COURSE 160 PREPARATION NOTES | NOTE 10 OF 10

Physical Test 2: Readiness, Recovery, and Test-Day Execution

Use your official event list

Confirm the events, order, minimums, footwear, clothing, and reporting instructions from your current official communication. Do not guess what will be tested from another course or another candidate's account. If an instruction is unclear, contact the recruiting centre through its official channel.

Practise the event, not just general fitness

Once you know the events, practise their movement patterns safely. For a timed run, include easy running and occasional controlled pace work after you have built a base. For strength repetitions, use correct form and practise stopping at the required range of motion. Avoid all-out practice every day; it can reduce performance and cause injury.

Turn a confirmed run target into a pace

Do not train to an unverified online standard. Once your call-up instructions give you the actual distance and time, divide target time by distance to get the average pace per kilometre.

Illustrative arithmetic only: if a confirmed practice target were 1.6 km in 8 minutes, 8 ÷ 1.6 = 5 minutes per kilometre. A 400 m lap at that even pace would take about 2 minutes. This example is not an Army standard. Use it to avoid sprinting the first lap and fading; practise controlled pacing at a safe effort.

For a repetition event, first confirm the required start, range of motion, and rest rules from the examiner or official instructions. Count only clean repetitions in training. If your form fails, pause or end the set; practising invalid repetitions teaches the wrong movement.

Taper in the final week

Keep light movement, but reduce training volume and avoid unfamiliar hard workouts. Do not try to make up months of training in a few days. Prioritise sleep, ordinary meals, and hydration. If you are ill or injured, get appropriate medical guidance and follow the official process rather than hiding a safety issue.

The day before

- Check your reporting time, route, documents, and permitted items.
- Prepare comfortable, appropriate clothing and footwear already tested in training.
- Eat familiar meals; do not experiment with supplements or energy products.
- Set an alarm and allow time for travel and check-in.
- Do a light walk or mobility only if it is part of your normal routine.

During the test

Listen to the examiner's demonstration and exact instructions. Warm up gently if permitted. Start at a controlled effort rather than sprinting the first part of an endurance event. For repetitions, maintain the required form and rhythm. Between events, recover, breathe steadily, and avoid comparing your pace with other candidates.

If an event has multiple stations, use the gap to reset: relax your shoulders, take steady breaths, listen for the next instruction, and mentally rehearse only the movement rules. Do not waste the rest period calculating other candidates' results or trying an unapproved warm-up.

Stop and inform staff if you experience severe pain, dizziness, chest discomfort, or another concerning symptom. Safety is more important than trying to conceal a problem.

Afterward

Cool down with easy walking if appropriate, drink normally, and note what went well and what needs work. Do not judge your future from one practice or from rumours about another person's result.

Common mistakes

- Starting a new training programme too close to the test.
- Testing a maximum every day.
- Wearing new shoes or using unfamiliar supplements on test day.
- Skipping sleep, meals, or warm-up because of nerves.
- Ignoring pain to appear tough.

Reminder

This is general preparation guidance. Follow the current official instructions and qualified medical advice. No plan can guarantee a particular score or selection outcome.

Research basis

The WHO physical activity fact sheet (https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/physical-activity) is a source for general health guidance, not recruitment criteria. Consult the Join Pakistan Army portal (https://joinpakarmy.gov.pk/) and your current call-up instructions for official events, timings, clothing, and reporting details; the accessible public information reviewed did not verify Long Course 160-specific physical standards.